



Xiaomi tablets

According to xda-developers, Xiaomi is working on at least three new high-end Android tablets. <http://digit.in/may21-15>



Insta story captions

Instagram is adding a new nifty feature that allows users to add captions to their stories via a sticker. <http://digit.in/may21-16>

Graphics cards prices could normalise later this year

With Ethereum moving to Proof-of-Stake model, miners have little time to break even on their investments

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It's no secret that one of the primary reasons for the sky-high graphics card prices are

miners. The problem has become so rampant that NVIDIA has created a new CMP HX series of graphics cards just for mining and has even gated hashing performance on their consumer graphics cards. The other reasons for the high prices can be chalked up to the global shortage of chips, impact of Covid-19 on production and the higher sales since people have started working from home and have had to build new systems for their home offices. While most of these reasons are expected to normalise by the end of this year and early next year, the problem of miners is here to stay. Or so we thought.

Ethereum, one of the primary cryptocurrencies that is still mined using graphics cards, has announced a major change to their working as part of the ETH 2.0 strategy. It will be moving from a Proof-of-Work model to a Proof-of-Stake model. To understand the impact of this change, we'll first need to understand what these models are.

Cryptocurrencies such as Bitcoin and Ethereum are built on a blockchain ledger. Every single transaction made within their respective ecosystems is recorded on this

blockchain. In a Proof-of-Work model, the changes have to be validated by a vast majority of users who do so by means of computation power. This is called a consensus mechanism. Miners have to churn through millions of transactions before they can validate a transaction onto the blockchain and in return for offering their valuable computational power, they're rewarded with a block reward. Bitcoin, for example, rewards

tocurrencies are mined and there are only a finite amount of cryptocurrencies within each ecosystem. As the blockchain grows larger, it becomes harder to mine coins and the value of each coin goes up in proportion to the effort required.

Proof-of-Stake requires users to put up a stake of 32 ETH to get the role of a validator within the consensus mechanism i.e. they have to stake their own cryptocurrencies.



miners who complete one block with 6.25 Bitcoins and that reward reduces over time. Initially, the reward was 50 BTC per block. Soon we'll see the reward drop to 3.125 BTC per block. This is how Bitcoin and Ethereum currently work. This is how cryp-

If they validate transactions without error and are honest, they get to keep their stake. However, if they're dishonest then their stake of 32 ETH will be confiscated.

By moving from a Proof-of-Work to Proof-of-Stake model, the amount of